Tomislav Mesarić

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Butcher and meat-counter professional with experience since 2015 in carcass breakdown, boning, trimming, portioning and customer service. Confident advising customers on cuts and preparation, making fresh sausages, and maintaining cold-chain temperature and hygiene checks. Completed vocational butcher training and holds a renewed basic HACCP certificate.

KEY SKILLS

Carcass breakdown (beef, pork and lamb) · Boning, trimming and portioning · Fresh sausage production · Customer advice on cuts and preparation · FIFO stock rotation · Cold-chain temperature checks · HACCP and hygiene routines · Knife sharpening · Mincer and bandsaw operation · Cash handling

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Butcher *Mesnica Kod Ante (family butcher shop), Zagreb | 2019–present*

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides each week; bone, trim and portion meat for the counter.
- Make four kinds of fresh sausage to the shop's recipes: ćevapi, kobasice, chipolata and lamb merguez. Produce about 40 kg weekly in the busy season.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the ćevapi mix to 70% beef / 30% lamb in response to customer feedback. The ćevapi won second place at the Zagreb County craft meat fair in 2023.
- Record cold-room (0–4 °C) and display-counter temperature checks twice daily; rotate cold-room stock every morning using FIFO.
- Serve around 120 customers on a Saturday, advising on cuts and cooking times.
- Trained two apprentices in knife handling and cleaning routines.
- Prepared whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting at weddings and family events, including a 2024 wedding order for four lambs and two pigs serving 180 guests.
- Ran a six-week dry-ageing trial on beef ribs, recording temperatures and weight loss; the shop now sells dry-aged rib by pre-order.

Counter Assistant *Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall, Zagreb | 2015–2019*

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers and the counter at closing.
- Created a closing and cleaning checklist for equipment and work areas following a market hygiene inspection remark; it remains in use at the stall.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATES

Vocational Certificate: Butcher (3-year programme) | Food Trades School Zagreb | 2015
HACCP Basic Food Hygiene Certificate | 2021; renewed 2024
Preparing for the Master Butcher exam (majstorski ispit), planned for spring 2027; not yet passed

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) · English (good; customer communication) · German (basic)